India which continues till date and will be so in future, without any iota of doubt in it.

(ii) **Poverty Alleviation:** Poverty alleviation was the most important issue which polarised the members of the NPC as well as the Constituent Assembly that a highly emphatic decision in favour of a planned economy evolved even before independence. Several programmes have been launched in India directing the cause of poverty alleviation by all the Governments till date and the process continues even today with more seriousness (we see the National Rural Employment Guarantee Programme—NREGP—being launched by the UPA Government in 2006 by passing an Act in the Parliament—the matter has started attracting such high political concern!).

(iii) **Employment Generation:** Providing employment to the poor has been the best tool of economics to alleviate poverty. Thus, this objective of planning in India comes naturally once it commit0ted itself to alleviate poverty. Employment generation in India has been, therefore, part and parcel of the objective of poverty alleviation in India. General programmes and schemes have been launched by the Governments from time to time in this direction, some based on the wage employments still, others based on self-employment.

(iv) **Controlling Economic Inequality:** There were visible economic inequalities in India at the inter-personal as well as at the intra-personal levels. Economic planning as a tool of checking all kinds of economic disparities and inequalities was an accepted idea by the time India started planning.[36] To fulfill this objective of planning the Governments have enacted highly innovative economic policies at times even inviting a tussle with regard to the Fundamental Rights Constitution.

Though Indian Planning has socioeconomic objectives to fulfill, only economic planning was made a part of the planning process (technically speaking) and social planning (better called social engineering) was left to the political process. That is why reservation in government jobs and admissions in premier academic